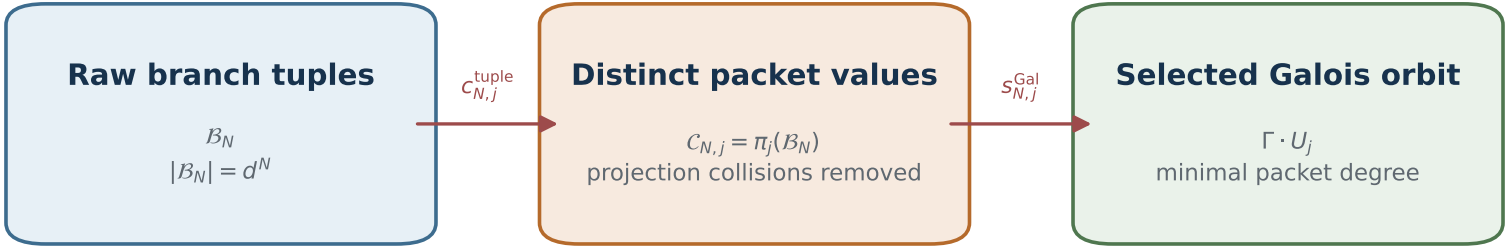
Two-stage algebraic branch-collision ledger



$$d^N - \deg_{K(x)} U_j = (d^N - |\mathcal{C}_{N,j}|) + (|\mathcal{C}_{N,j}| - |\Gamma \cdot U_j|)$$

Tuple collision is caused by the packet coordinate projection. Stabilizer loss is caused by descent of the selected value. The two mechanisms are finite, exact, and must not be merged into one unexplained degree drop.